MANIT KHERA

0412 761 206 | manitkhera26@gmail.com
Blackburn South, VIC 3130 | linkedin.com/in/manit-khera-603957252

12 August 2026

DeakinTALENT Employer Services Team
Deakin University

Re: Application — Student Experience Ambassador, Burwood

Dear DeakinTALENT Employer Services Team,

I'm writing to express my interest in the Student Experience Ambassador role advertised through DeakinTALENT. But before I explain why I believe I would be a strong candidate, I want to begin with the reason this role means something personal to me.

A year ago, I walked into Orientation at Deakin having no idea where I belonged.

I had recently arrived in Australia as an international student. Starting university is already a strange experience: new people, new classes, new expectations and the uncomfortable feeling that everyone around you seems to understand what is happening slightly better than you do.

For me, there was another layer to it.

Deakin was new.

Australia was new.

Almost everyone and everything around me was new.

I remember walking through the Burwood campus during Orientation and being completely overwhelmed by how alive everything was. There were people everywhere. Music, clubs, stalls, conversations, groups of students already laughing with each other.

It should have felt exciting.

And part of me was excited.

But another part of me was standing in the middle of all of it thinking: **where exactly do I fit into this?**

I think that is one of the lonelier things about being new somewhere. You can be surrounded by thousands of people and still feel as though you are the only person who does not quite know what they are doing.

Then I met the students in the pink Deakin shirts.

I wish I could tell you I remember some profound piece of advice one of them gave me.

I don't.

What I remember is much simpler.

They were easy to talk to.

They smiled at me. They answered questions I was probably overthinking before I asked them. They spoke to me without making me feel like the new international student who did not know how anything worked.

For a few minutes, I was just another Deakin student.

That distinction mattered to me more than I understood at the time.

They did not magically make every nervous thought disappear. I still had to build friendships. I still had to learn the campus. I still had to adjust to university and to living in Australia.

But they made the place feel smaller.

A little more familiar.

A little more like somewhere I could eventually belong.

And eventually, it did become that place.

Over the following year, I joined the Software Engineering Club. Then the Data Science Club. I served on committees, helped run events, hosted networking sessions, worked with students I would never otherwise have met and became familiar with a campus that had once felt enormous.

One of the strangest parts of that experience has been slowly finding myself on the other side of the same conversation.

At Market Day, I began noticing the students who hovered around our stall without approaching. Sometimes they would walk past once, look over, keep going and eventually circle back.

I recognised that hesitation.

So I stopped thinking about how to give them the perfect pitch.

I started asking what they studied.

Because often that was enough.

They would tell me their degree. I would ask how they were finding it. One question became another, and suddenly someone who had been standing several metres away wondering whether to approach was having a normal conversation with another student.

That experience changed the way I think about student engagement.

I used to think helping someone meant having the information they needed.

Now I think it often begins earlier than that.

Sometimes helping someone means noticing that they have a question before they are comfortable asking it.

Sometimes it means starting the conversation for them.

Sometimes it simply means making sure that, for five minutes, they do not feel like the only person in the room who does not know where they belong.

That is why I am applying for the Student Experience Ambassador role.

I am not applying only because I enjoy meeting people or because I have experience representing student clubs. I am applying because I remember very clearly what it felt like to be the student this role exists for.

Since then, my involvement at Deakin has given me experience I would bring to the position. Across the Software Engineering and Data Science Clubs, I have helped engage students at Market Day activities that contributed to more than 100 new member sign-ups. I have hosted networking sessions, supported students through a 30-person debugging workshop and recently been selected as a Student Ambassador with Deakin Future Students for Open Day.

Outside university, working in customer service at 7-Eleven and volunteering with the Boroondara Stroke Support Group have also taught me how to stay patient, approachable and composed when the person in front of me is confused, frustrated or simply unsure what to ask.

But qualifications are only part of why I want this role.

There will be thousands of students moving through Burwood during Orientation and the major intake periods.

Some will arrive surrounded by friends.

Some will be confident enough to talk to everyone.

Some will only need to know where their next session is.

And somewhere among them will be another student who has just arrived in Australia, knows almost nobody, is surrounded by more people than they expected and is quietly wondering whether this enormous new place will ever feel like theirs.

I cannot make that adjustment for them.

The ambassadors I met could not make it for me either.

But they could make the first day easier.

They could make the first question less intimidating.

They could make Deakin feel a little less unfamiliar.

And sometimes, when you are new, that is enough to matter.

I am applying for the **Burwood campus**. I am currently enrolled in the Bachelor of Software Engineering (Honours) at Deakin University and will remain enrolled, continuing my studies throughout Trimesters 1 and 2 of 2027. My degree continues through to 2028.

A year ago, I was looking for the students in pink shirts because I needed their help.

This time, I would like to be wearing one.

Thank you for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,
Manit Khera